most distant galaxies we've seen have been at redshift values of about 11, and the cosmic microwave background is at a redshift of around 1,100.

So how do we see so many things that are so far away that they're receding from us at more than the speed of light, and, in fact, always have been? If something is moving away at more than the speed of light, a light beam emitted from it is getting farther away from us, not closer. The trick is that the light we're picking up left the source long ago, when the universe was smaller and the expansion was actually slowing. So a light beam that started out being carried by the expansion of space away from us (even though it was emitted in our direction) eventually was able to "catch up" as the expansion slowed and it reached a part of the universe that was close enough for the recession speed to be less than the speed of light. It entered our Hubble radius from the outside.

Imagine you're standing in the middle of a very long treadmill that's going faster than you can run. Even running at your top speed, you're going to be dropping back. But if you don't get dragged back too far, and if the treadmill slows down enough, you can eventually make up the lost ground and start to move forward before falling off the back end. So if you're in a universe whose expansion is slowing down, you'll be able to see more and more distant objects as time goes on, as the light from distant objects catches up with the expansion. The "safe zone" in which the expansion speed is less than the speed of light, the Hubble radius, grows over time and envelops objects that were previously outside it. Our horizons,[fn7] so to speak, expand.